Organizational Capacity Index

Capacity Coach report: response record and recommendations

Southside Youth Peace Collective (synthetic sample)

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Community Safety Fund | Everytown for Gun Safety

Generated from synthetic or scrubbed data for the AWS Breaking Barriers demo.

Recommendations generated with AI (Claude on Amazon Bedrock) from your answers and the CVI resource library. Scores are calculated by a fixed scoring method.

What's true about you

Southside Youth Peace Collective has earned something money cannot buy. Young people and families trust you. That trust is the heart of violence interruption and mentoring work, and it is why a small team in its third year is already known in the neighborhood.

Right now, all four areas we looked at (Planning, Fundraising, Financial Management, and Monitoring, Learning and Evaluation) are at the Seeding stage. Seeding is the very first stage. It is where most young organizations begin. It means the work is real, but much of it lives in people's heads, and the founder and executive director carry most of the back-office load. That is normal for a team your size. It also means a lot depends on two people.

The good news is that you already have some building blocks. You have an accounting system, an annual budget, a base of supporters, and a way to count who you serve. The next step is to write things down and set simple routines. This report suggests starting with two things: a steady money check-in, and a one-page plan with clear goals. These two unlock the rest. They also make it easier to ask for steadier funding beyond one city contract.

Start here: your top priorities

If you only do one or two things first, do these.

1. Start a simple monthly money routine

Your answers show that meeting payroll consistently is a growth priority, and you do not yet compare spending to your budget each month. With one city contract and small gifts, a late payment could hit your four staff hard. A steady routine protects your people and shows funders you are ready for more.

Based on your answers:

- FM4: We are able to meet payroll and financial obligations consistently.
- FM6: We track financial performance and compare actuals to our budget.
- FM8: We produce financial reports (e.g., income statement, balance sheet) and review them regularly.

What to do

- Once a month, the executive director and the bookkeeper sit down for 60 minutes. Look at money in, money out, and what the budget said.
- Make a simple cash calendar for the next 12 weeks. Mark when payroll is due and

when city contract payments usually arrive. Circle any weeks that look tight.
- Print a one-page summary from your accounting system (money in, money out, compared to budget). Share it with the board chair each quarter.
- Write down what you would do if a payment came late, such as who to call and what to delay.

Resource: ARCvi: Finding and Sustaining Funding https://arcvi.org/finding-and-sustaining-funding/

2. Write a one-page plan with clear goals and outcomes

Staff cannot yet clearly say the organization's goals, and you do not have a written work plan or defined program outcomes. Because so much sits with the founder and executive director, a shared plan helps everyone pull in the same direction. It also gives funders the proof they want to see.

Based on your answers:

- PL2: We have written work plans, a logic model, or a strategy plan to guide our work.
- PL3: Staff across the organization can clearly articulate our goals.
- ML3: We have defined outcomes or goals for our programs.

What to do

- Hold one staff meeting to write 3 to 5 goals in plain words. Use the voices of the people who do the street and mentoring work.
- For violence interruption and for youth mentoring, name 2 or 3 changes you want to see. Example: fewer retaliation incidents, or more youth staying in school and in the program.
- Put it on one page: goals, activities, who is responsible, and a rough timeline. The BJA checklist calls this a roadmap, or logic model, and it is a good guide.
- At the next two staff meetings, ask each person to say the goals in their own words. Fix the wording until it feels true to everyone.

Resource: Community Based Violence Intervention and Prevention Initiative Implementation Checklist (April 2022) https://www.ojp.gov/sites/ojp/files/media/document/cvi-implementation-checklist_0.pdf

What you already do well

- Young people and families trust you. Credibility with the people you serve is your greatest asset, and you cannot buy it.
- You already use an accounting system and create and manage an annual budget. Financial duties are shared, which adds a layer of oversight.
- You have a base of financial supporters, you raise money beyond donated time and space, and you have won grants of $10,000 or more.
- You know where funding will come from for at least the next 6 to 12 months, which gives you some breathing room to plan.
- You track basic program activity, collect information about the people and communities you serve, and have someone responsible for data and evaluation.

Organization profile

Grassroots, founded 2023, 4 staff (2 full time), about $310K budget. A neighborhood-rooted violence interruption and youth mentoring group in its third year. Credibility with young people and families is its greatest asset; nearly all back-office function runs through the founder and executive director. Funding is one city contract plus small individual gifts.

Assessment overview

Statements assessed	Growth priorities	High	Medium	Low
72	60	20	20	20

Overall favorable response rate: 16.7% (12 of 72 statements). The per-domain percentages below are the figures used in planning; the overall rate is a headline only and is not an input to any scoring decision.

Domain results

Domain	Estimated stage	Capacity	Growth priorities	High priority
PL · Planning	Seeding	13.3%	13 / 15	7
FR · Fundraising	Seeding	20.0%	16 / 20	5
FM · Financial Management	Seeding	15.0%	17 / 20	5
ML · Monitoring, Learning & Evaluation	Seeding	17.6%	14 / 17	3

Stage key

1. Seeding: Early formation. Activity is reactive and largely informal; systems are not yet written down.

2. Emerging: First structures appear. Basic documents and routines exist but are applied unevenly.

3. Developing: Systems are in place and used consistently across the organization.

4. Strengthening: Systems are mature, integrated with one another, and actively managed.

5. Transformational: The organization operates as a sector model and supports the growth of peer organizations.

30 / 60 / 90 day action plan

First 30 days

Make a one-page funding map

Owner: Executive director

Why: You know your funding for the next 6 to 12 months, but you rely on one city contract and small gifts. Writing it down shows how exposed you are and where to build.

- List every funder and donor with the amount, what it can be used for, and when it ends or renews.
- Mark each one as confirmed or still pending.
- Note the end date of the city contract and what share of your budget it covers.
- Circle one or two funders who might offer multi-year support.

Based on: FR7, PL9, FR5

Resource: ARCvi: Finding and Sustaining Funding https://arcvi.org/finding-and-sustaining-funding/

Gather your key documents in one shared folder

Owner: Program manager

Why: Most back-office knowledge sits with two people. A shared folder means the work can continue if either of them is out, and it is ready when a funder asks.

- Collect what you already have: mission statement, budget, contracts, policies, and program descriptions.
- Put them in one shared, backed-up folder that at least three people can open.
- Make a short list of what is missing and pick the one or two most important to write next.

Based on: PL7

Days 31 to 60

Put simple financial controls in writing

Owner: Executive director with the board chair

Why: Close to all financial tasks run through two people. Clear approval steps protect them and the organization, and funders look for this.

- Write down who can approve spending, who signs checks or makes payments, and who checks the bank statements.
- Make sure the person who approves a payment is not the only person who records it.

- Ask the board chair or another board member to look at the monthly one-page summary each quarter.
- Use the IRS governance guide to see which key policies a board should have.

Based on: FM7, FM8

Resource: Governance and Related Topics: 501(c)(3) Organizations https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-tege/governance_practices.pdf

Build a 6 to 12 month work plan and check it monthly

Owner: Program manager

Why: Your one-page plan needs dates and owners to become a working tool. Right now you mostly plan short term and do not check progress against a written plan.

- For each program, list tasks, deadlines, and the person responsible. The BJA checklist says to build this with your key partners.
- Pick a monthly team meeting to review the plan. Ask what is done, what is stuck, and what changed.
- Ask what success looks like at 30 and 90 days for your biggest tasks.
- Update the plan every quarter and share the new version with the whole team.

Based on: PL5, PL6, PL8

Resource: Community Based Violence Intervention and Prevention Initiative Implementation Checklist (April 2022) https://www.ojp.gov/sites/ojp/files/media/document/cvi-implementation-checklist_0.pdf

Choose simple measures and one place to keep the data

Owner: Data and evaluation lead

Why: You already count participants and services. Now you need to track progress toward the outcomes you named, using one consistent tool and a shared way of entering data.

- For each outcome you named, pick one or two things you can count or ask about, such as youth contacts, conflicts mediated, or youth engaged after 90 days.
- Set up one spreadsheet or simple database with the same fields for everyone.
- Hold a short training so each staff member knows what to enter and when. Mention it in supervision.
- Review the free templates and trainings in ARCvi: Using Data That Matters.

Based on: ML4, ML7, ML6

Resource: ARCvi: Using Data That Matters https://arcvi.org/using-data-that-matters/

Days 61 to 90

Review your data together as a team

Owner: Program manager

Why: Data helps most when the people doing the work look at it together. This also gives you real numbers and stories for funders.

- Set a recurring monthly or quarterly meeting to look at your numbers.
- Share a few key numbers with all staff, and ask what they see on the ground.
- Pick one small change to try based on what you learn, and note it in your work plan.

Based on: ML5, ML8

Resource: ARCvi: Using Data That Matters https://arcvi.org/using-data-that-matters/

Ask for steadier, more flexible funding and start a basic fundraising plan

Owner: Executive director

Why: Relying on one city contract is a risk. Multi-year and flexible money pays for rent, payroll, and back-office needs that program-only grants often do not cover.

- Using your funding map, choose 3 funders or donor groups to approach. Look beyond grants to residents, faith communities, and local businesses.
- Ask for multi-year or general operating support, and explain how stability protects staff and young people.
- Write a short fundraising plan: targets, sources, timeline, and who does what. Ask a board member or volunteer to share the work.
- Use your outcomes and a few consent-based stories to show your impact.

Based on: FR5, FR6, FR9, FR13

Resource: ARCvi: Finding and Sustaining Funding https://arcvi.org/finding-and-sustaining-funding/

Learn what it costs to serve one young person and look into an outside financial review

Owner: Executive director with the bookkeeper

Why: Knowing your true cost helps you set fair budgets and ask for the right amount. An outside review, as your funding grows, builds trust with funders.

- Use the costing guide to add up staff time, supervision, supplies, and shared costs for each program.
- Divide by the number of people served to get a rough cost per participant.
- Ask your city contract manager and one local accountant what review or audit is expected at

your funding level.

- Get a quote for an outside review and decide whether to plan for it in next year's budget.

Based on: FM5, FM6

Resource: Hospital-Based Violence Intervention Programs: A Guide to Implementation and Costing (2024) https://everytownresearch.org/report/hospital-based-violence-intervention-programs

Priority action plan

The 12 highest-scoring growth priorities across all assessed domains, ranked by priority score. Full domain-by-domain detail follows.

#	ID	Domain	Statement	Score	Priority
1	PL2	Planning	We have written work plans, a logic model, or a strategy plan to guide our work.	7.47	High
2	PL3	Planning	Staff across the organization can clearly articulate our goals.	7.47	High
3	FM4	Financial Management	We are able to meet payroll and financial obligations consistently.	7.40	High
4	FR5	Fundraising	We receive funding commitments that extend beyond one-time or single-year support.	7.20	High
5	ML3	Monitoring, Learning & Evaluation	We have defined outcomes or goals for our programs.	5.84	High
6	ML4	Monitoring, Learning & Evaluation	We track progress toward our program outcomes.	5.84	High
7	PL5	Planning	We maintain written work plans that guide activities over the next 6–12 months.	5.60	High
8	PL6	Planning	We consistently monitor progress against our written work plans.	5.60	High
9	PL7	Planning	We maintain written documents that describe our mission, context, strategies, budget, and policies.	5.60	High
10	PL8	Planning	We regularly develop and update our work plans.	5.60	High
11	PL9	Planning	We have a clear understanding of where funding will come from for the next year.	5.60	High
12	FM5	Financial Management	We have completed at least one independent financial review or audit.	5.55	High

Recommendations by domain

Every growth priority, grouped by domain and ordered by priority score. Domains with no growth priorities are listed as complete and carry no recommendations.

PL · Planning

Capacity 13.3% | Estimated stage: Seeding | Growth priorities: 13 of 15

[High] PL2: We have written work plans, a logic model, or a strategy plan to guide our work.

Stage: Emerging · Priority score: 7.47

Suggested next steps:

- Start with one basic written work plan (goals, activities, timeline, owner)
- Create a simple logic model to connect activities to outcomes
- Build toward a shared set of core planning documents over time

[High] PL3: Staff across the organization can clearly articulate our goals.

Stage: Emerging · Priority score: 7.47

Suggested next steps:

- Write 3–5 clear organizational goals in plain language
- Share goals regularly in meetings and internal materials
- Ask staff to reflect goals back to confirm shared understanding

[High] PL5: We maintain written work plans that guide activities over the next 6–12 months.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.60

Suggested next steps:

- Develop a 6–12 month work plan for each major program area
- Assign ownership and timelines for key activities
- Use work plans to guide regular team check-ins

[High] PL6: We consistently monitor progress against our written work plans.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.60

Suggested next steps:

- Establish a consistent cadence (monthly or quarterly) to review progress
- Identify key milestones or metrics tied to your plan
- Document updates and adjust activities based on what you learn

[High] PL7: We maintain written documents that describe our mission, context, strategies, budget, and policies.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.60

Suggested next steps:

- Compile existing documents into one accessible location
- Identify gaps and prioritize missing materials
- Develop 1–2 key documents at a time

[High] PL8: We regularly develop and update our work plans.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.60

Suggested next steps:

- Set a regular schedule (quarterly or biannually) to update plans
- Incorporate lessons learned and changing priorities
- Share updates across the team

[High] PL9: We have a clear understanding of where funding will come from for the next year.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.60

Suggested next steps:

- Map expected funding across the next 12 months
- Identify confirmed vs. pending sources
- Align program commitments with funding reality

[Medium] PL10: We are actively developing a strategic plan.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.73

Suggested next steps:

- Define 2–3 year priorities and outcomes
- Engage staff and stakeholders in shaping direction
- Use a structured planning template or facilitator

[Medium] PL11: We have a 2–3 year strategic plan that includes a multi-year budget, capacity building, and sustainability strategies.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.73

Suggested next steps:

- Develop a multi-year plan with clear goals and strategies
- Align budget projections with strategic priorities
- Identify capacity and sustainability needs

[Medium] PL12: Our strategic plan is updated regularly and connected to operational or work plans.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.73

Suggested next steps:

- Link strategic priorities to annual or program work plans
- Revisit and update the plan annually
- Use it to guide decision-making

[Medium] PL13: We have a clear understanding of where funding will come from for the next 2 or more years.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.73

Suggested next steps:

- Project funding across a 2+ year period
- Identify and pursue multi-year funding opportunities
- Align growth decisions with long-term funding expectations

[Low] PL14: We are implementing our second or subsequent strategic plan.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.87

Suggested next steps:

- Document lessons learned from your current or first plan
- Use those insights to strengthen your next planning cycle
- Establish a repeatable planning → implementation → reflection process

[Low] PL15: We serve as a model for other organizations in planning and strategy.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.87

Suggested next steps:

- Identify and document one strong planning practice
- Share tools or lessons learned with peers
- Participate in peer learning opportunities

FR · Fundraising

Capacity 20.0% | Estimated stage: Seeding | Growth priorities: 16 of 20

[High] FR5: We receive funding commitments that extend beyond one-time or single-year support.

Stage: Emerging · Priority score: 7.20

Suggested next steps:

- Prioritize funders that offer multi-year or renewable support
- Frame funding requests around sustained impact
- Track renewal opportunities and build long-term relationships

[High] FR6: We maintain a balance of restricted and flexible (unrestricted) funding.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.40

Suggested next steps:

- Identify opportunities to request general operating support
- Clearly communicate organizational needs beyond specific programs
- Track the proportion of restricted vs. unrestricted funding

[High] FR7: We have visibility into funding sources covering at least the next year.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.40

Suggested next steps:

- Map expected funding across a 12-month period
- Identify confirmed vs. pending sources
- Align program commitments with funding expectations

[High] FR8: We secure grants at moderate funding levels (e.g., $25,000–$75,000).

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.40

Suggested next steps:

- Identify funders that operate at this funding range
- Strengthen proposals with clearer outcomes and impact data
- Leverage partnerships or introductions to access larger opportunities

[High] FR9: We have a mix of multi-year donors and funding sources that support both programs and operations.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.40

Suggested next steps:

- Diversify funding across individuals, foundations, and public sources
- Prioritize both program-specific and general operating funding
- Develop a basic fundraising plan to guide outreach

[Medium] FR10: We secure grants at higher funding levels (e.g., $75,000+).

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Identify funders aligned with larger-scale investments
- Strengthen organizational narrative, outcomes, and financials
- Build relationships before applying for higher-value opportunities

[Medium] FR11: We have a diverse base of multi-year funders across sectors.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Map current funders and identify gaps by sector
- Target new funders across foundations, government, and private sector
- Strengthen relationship management with existing supporters

[Medium] FR12: A meaningful portion of our funding is flexible and can be used strategically.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Request general operating support in proposals
- Communicate organizational priorities beyond individual programs
- Track and increase flexible funding over time

[Medium] FR13: We have a written fundraising or resource development plan.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Create a simple plan outlining targets, sources, and timelines
- Assign responsibility for fundraising activities
- Review and update the plan annually

[Medium] FR14: We have visibility into funding sources over a 3-year horizon.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Project funding across a 2–3 year period
- Identify multi-year opportunities and renewals
- Align growth plans with long-term funding expectations

[Low] FR15: We have dedicated capacity (staff or consultant) focused on fundraising.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Assign fundraising responsibility to a specific team member
- Use external support (consultants, partners) as needed
- Build internal fundraising skills through training and tools

[Low] FR16: We secure at least some large grants (e.g., $75,000+ or higher).

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Target funders known for larger investments
- Strengthen organizational infrastructure and financial reporting
- Build relationships over time before applying

[Low] FR17: We have taken steps to build long-term financial sustainability (e.g., reserves, multi-year funding).

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.60

Suggested next steps:

- Identify opportunities to build reserves or flexible funding
- Prioritize multi-year funding relationships
- Develop a sustainability strategy aligned with growth

[Low] FR18: Our fundraising plan has been implemented and refined over time.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.80

Suggested next steps:

- Implement your existing plan and track progress
- Review results annually and refine strategies
- Document lessons learned to strengthen future efforts

[Low] FR19: We have more than one person supporting fundraising efforts.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.80

Suggested next steps:

- Engage leadership, board, or staff in fundraising roles
- Define clear responsibilities for fundraising activities
- Build a team-based approach over time

[Low] FR20: We have secured at least one very large grant (e.g., $150,000+).

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.80

Suggested next steps:

- Identify funders that provide large-scale investments
- Strengthen proposals with strong outcomes and financials
- Build long-term relationships before pursuing large grants

FM · Financial Management

Capacity 15.0% | Estimated stage: Seeding | Growth priorities: 17 of 20

[High] FM4: We are able to meet payroll and financial obligations consistently.

Stage: Emerging · Priority score: 7.40

Suggested next steps:

- Review cash flow to identify timing gaps
- Align expenses with confirmed funding
- Build a short-term cash management plan

[High] FM5: We have completed at least one independent financial review or audit.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.55

Suggested next steps:

- Explore requirements for audits based on funding levels
- Engage an external accountant or firm
- Prepare financial records for review

[High] FM6: We track financial performance and compare actuals to our budget.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.55

Suggested next steps:

- Review income and expenses monthly
- Compare actuals against budget projections
- Adjust spending or projections as needed

[High] FM7: We have financial controls in place to manage risk and ensure accountability.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.55

Suggested next steps:

- Establish clear processes for approvals and payments
- Document financial procedures

- Assign oversight responsibility to leadership or board

[High] FM8: We produce financial reports (e.g., income statement, balance sheet) and review them regularly.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 5.55

Suggested next steps:

- Generate basic financial reports monthly or quarterly
- Review reports with leadership or board
- Use reports to inform decision-making

[Medium] FM9: We have been audited more than once and have improved based on findings.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Address any prior audit findings
- Strengthen financial systems and documentation
- Plan for ongoing audits as funding grows

[Medium] FM10: We file required taxes and financial documents accurately and on time.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Identify filing requirements and deadlines
- Assign responsibility for compliance
- Engage external support if needed

[Medium] FM11: We develop multi-year budgets and financial projections.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Extend your budget planning beyond one year
- Align projections with funding pipeline
- Use projections to guide hiring and growth

[Medium] FM12: We manage financial reserves, assets, or investments to support sustainability.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Identify opportunities to build reserves
- Set aside funds when possible

- Develop a basic reserve policy

[Medium] FM13: Financial reports are reviewed regularly by leadership and/or the governing body.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Share reports with leadership or board quarterly
- Use a standard format for review
- Document key takeaways and decisions

[Medium] FM14: Our financial performance generally aligns with our budget projections.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Analyze variances between budget and actuals
- Adjust projections based on trends
- Strengthen forecasting practices

[Medium] FM15: We produce financial reports that track spending across programs or funding streams.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Categorize expenses by program or grant
- Track spending against each funding source
- Use reports to inform program decisions

[Medium] FM16: We complete independent audits annually as required.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 3.70

Suggested next steps:

- Determine audit requirements based on funding
- Engage an external auditor
- Establish a timeline for annual audits

[Low] FM17: Our audits demonstrate consistent financial strength over time.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.85

Suggested next steps:

- Address recurring audit issues
- Strengthen internal controls and documentation
- Build consistency in financial practices

[Low] FM18: Our financial planning and performance are transparent and understood by stakeholders.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.85

Suggested next steps:

- Share financial summaries with staff and board
- Communicate key financial priorities
- Build financial literacy across the organization

[Low] FM19: We complete audits in a timely manner following the close of the fiscal year.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.85

Suggested next steps:

- Establish a clear audit timeline
- Prepare documents in advance
- Coordinate closely with auditors

[Low] FM20: Our organization is recognized for strong financial management practices.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.85

Suggested next steps:

- Strengthen consistency in financial systems
- Document and share best practices
- Build credibility with funders and partners

ML · Monitoring, Learning & Evaluation

Capacity 17.6% | Estimated stage: Seeding | Growth priorities: 14 of 17

[High] ML3: We have defined outcomes or goals for our programs.

Stage: Emerging · Priority score: 5.84

Suggested next steps:

- Identify 2–3 desired outcomes for each program
- Align outcomes with your mission and activities
- Document outcomes in a simple framework

[High] ML4: We track progress toward our program outcomes.

Stage: Emerging · Priority score: 5.84

Suggested next steps:

- Identify indicators tied to each outcome
- Track progress at regular intervals
- Use simple tools to monitor outcomes over time

[High] ML5: We use data to inform program decisions and improvements.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 4.38

Suggested next steps:

- Review data regularly (monthly or quarterly)
- Identify trends and areas for improvement
- Adjust programming based on insights

[Medium] ML6: Staff are trained to collect and use data consistently.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 4.38

Suggested next steps:

- Provide basic training on data collection tools and processes
- Create simple guidelines for data entry and use
- Reinforce expectations through supervision

[Medium] ML7: We use standardized tools or systems to collect and manage data.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 4.38

Suggested next steps:

- Select a consistent platform (spreadsheet, CRM, database)
- Standardize forms and templates
- Train staff on consistent usage

[Medium] ML8: We regularly review program data as a team.

Stage: Developing · Priority score: 4.38

Suggested next steps:

- Schedule recurring data review sessions
- Share key metrics with staff
- Use discussions to inform program adjustments

[Low] ML9: We share program data with external stakeholders (e.g., funders, partners).

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 2.92

Suggested next steps:

- Develop simple reports or summaries
- Identify key audiences and reporting needs
- Share data regularly to build transparency and trust

[Low] ML10: We use data to support fundraising and external communications.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 2.92

Suggested next steps:

- Incorporate data into proposals and reports
- Highlight outcomes and impact in communications
- Align data with funder priorities

[Low] ML12: We assess program effectiveness beyond outputs (e.g., changes in behavior, safety, or outcomes).

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 2.92

Suggested next steps:

- Define indicators that reflect deeper impact
- Collect qualitative and/or outcome-based data
- Use findings to refine program design

[Low] ML13: We partner with external evaluators, researchers, or learning partners when appropriate.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 2.92

Suggested next steps:

- Identify potential academic or research partners
- Explore opportunities for evaluation support
- Start with small, focused evaluation efforts

[Low] ML14: We use data and learning to adapt programs over time.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 2.92

Suggested next steps:

- Document lessons learned from data reviews
- Make adjustments to program design
- Track changes and their impact

[Low] ML15: We have systems in place to ensure data quality and consistency.

Stage: Strengthening · Priority score: 2.92

Suggested next steps:

- Create basic data entry standards
- Review data for accuracy regularly
- Provide feedback to staff

[Low] ML16: We have a learning agenda or set of questions guiding our evaluation efforts.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.46

Suggested next steps:

- Identify 2–3 key questions you want to answer
- Align data collection to those questions
- Use findings to guide strategy

[Low] ML17: We contribute data, insights, or practices to broader field learning.

Stage: Transformational · Priority score: 1.46

Suggested next steps:

- Share findings with partners or networks
- Participate in learning communities
- Document and share promising practices

Team conversation guide

1. If our city contract ended or was paid late, how many weeks could we pay staff? What would we do first?
2. Which parts of our back-office work sit only with the founder or executive director? Who could share one of them this quarter?
3. In our own words, what 3 to 5 goals are we working toward? Do all four staff say them the same way?
4. What changes in young people and the neighborhood do we want to see? What is one simple thing we could count to know it is happening?
5. Which funder or supporter could we ask for multi-year or flexible support this year, and who on the team or board will help us make the ask?

Sources consulted

• ARCvi: Finding and Sustaining Funding https://arcvi.org/finding-and-sustaining-funding/

• Community Based Violence Intervention and Prevention Initiative Implementation Checklist (April 2022) https://www.ojp.gov/sites/ojp/files/media/document/cvi-implementation-checklist_0.pdf

• Governance and Related Topics: 501(c)(3) Organizations https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-tege/governance_practices.pdf

• ARCvi: Using Data That Matters https://arcvi.org/using-data-that-matters/

• Hospital-Based Violence Intervention Programs: A Guide to Implementation and Costing (2024) https://everytownresearch.org/report/hospital-based-violence-intervention-programs

Appendix A: Full response record

The complete answer set submitted for Southside Youth Peace Collective (synthetic sample): all 72 statements, in questionnaire order. "Favorable" means the answer did not register a growth priority. For reverse-coded statements (marked †) the favorable answer is No.

PL · Planning

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
PL1	We primarily focus on short-term planning and activities. †	No	1	Yes
PL2	We have written work plans, a logic model, or a strategy plan to guide our work.	No	2	Growth priority
PL3	Staff across the organization can clearly articulate our goals.	No	2	Growth priority
PL4	We have clarity on where funding will come from to support our programs for at least the next 6–12 months.	Yes	2	Yes
PL5	We maintain written work plans that guide activities over the next 6–12 months.	No	3	Growth priority
PL6	We consistently monitor progress against our written work plans.	No	3	Growth priority
PL7	We maintain written documents that describe our mission, context, strategies, budget, and policies.	No	3	Growth priority
PL8	We regularly develop and update our work plans.	No	3	Growth priority
PL9	We have a clear understanding of where funding will come from for the next year.	No	3	Growth priority
PL10	We are actively developing a strategic plan.	No	4	Growth priority
PL11	We have a 2–3 year strategic plan that includes a multi-year budget, capacity building, and sustainability strategies.	No	4	Growth priority
PL12	Our strategic plan is updated regularly and connected to operational or work plans.	No	4	Growth priority
PL13	We have a clear understanding of where funding will come from for the next 2 or more years.	No	4	Growth priority
PL14	We are implementing our second or subsequent strategic plan.	No	5	Growth priority

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
PL15	We serve as a model for other organizations in planning and strategy.	No	5	Growth priority

FR · Fundraising

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
FR1	We have a base of financial supporters who contribute to our work.	Yes	1	Yes
FR2	We generate financial resources beyond in-kind support (e.g., volunteer time, donated space).	Yes	1	Yes
FR3	We have clarity on where funding will come from over the next 6–12 months.	Yes	2	Yes
FR4	We secure grants that meet or exceed small-dollar thresholds (e.g., $10,000+).	Yes	2	Yes
FR5	We receive funding commitments that extend beyond one-time or single-year support.	No	2	Growth priority
FR6	We maintain a balance of restricted and flexible (unrestricted) funding.	No	3	Growth priority
FR7	We have visibility into funding sources covering at least the next year.	No	3	Growth priority
FR8	We secure grants at moderate funding levels (e.g., $25,000–$75,000).	No	3	Growth priority
FR9	We have a mix of multi-year donors and funding sources that support both programs and operations.	No	3	Growth priority
FR10	We secure grants at higher funding levels (e.g., $75,000+).	No	4	Growth priority
FR11	We have a diverse base of multi-year funders across sectors.	No	4	Growth priority
FR12	A meaningful portion of our funding is flexible and can be used strategically.	No	4	Growth priority
FR13	We have a written fundraising or resource development plan.	No	4	Growth priority
FR14	We have visibility into funding sources over a 3-year horizon.	No	4	Growth priority

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
FR15	We have dedicated capacity (staff or consultant) focused on fundraising.	No	4	Growth priority
FR16	We secure at least some large grants (e.g., $75,000+ or higher).	No	4	Growth priority
FR17	We have taken steps to build long-term financial sustainability (e.g., reserves, multi-year funding).	No	4	Growth priority
FR18	Our fundraising plan has been implemented and refined over time.	No	5	Growth priority
FR19	We have more than one person supporting fundraising efforts.	No	5	Growth priority
FR20	We have secured at least one very large grant (e.g., $150,000+).	No	5	Growth priority

FM · Financial Management

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
FM1	We use an accounting system (software or structured tools) to manage our finances.	Yes	1	Yes
FM2	Financial responsibilities are shared to ensure oversight and accountability.	Yes	1	Yes
FM3	We develop and manage an annual organizational budget.	Yes	2	Yes
FM4	We are able to meet payroll and financial obligations consistently.	No	2	Growth priority
FM5	We have completed at least one independent financial review or audit.	No	3	Growth priority
FM6	We track financial performance and compare actuals to our budget.	No	3	Growth priority
FM7	We have financial controls in place to manage risk and ensure accountability.	No	3	Growth priority
FM8	We produce financial reports (e.g., income statement, balance sheet) and review them regularly.	No	3	Growth priority
FM9	We have been audited more than once and have improved based on findings.	No	4	Growth priority

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
FM10	We file required taxes and financial documents accurately and on time.	No	4	Growth priority
FM11	We develop multi-year budgets and financial projections.	No	4	Growth priority
FM12	We manage financial reserves, assets, or investments to support sustainability.	No	4	Growth priority
FM13	Financial reports are reviewed regularly by leadership and/or the governing body.	No	4	Growth priority
FM14	Our financial performance generally aligns with our budget projections.	No	4	Growth priority
FM15	We produce financial reports that track spending across programs or funding streams.	No	4	Growth priority
FM16	We complete independent audits annually as required.	No	4	Growth priority
FM17	Our audits demonstrate consistent financial strength over time.	No	5	Growth priority
FM18	Our financial planning and performance are transparent and understood by stakeholders.	No	5	Growth priority
FM19	We complete audits in a timely manner following the close of the fiscal year.	No	5	Growth priority
FM20	Our organization is recognized for strong financial management practices.	No	5	Growth priority

ML · Monitoring, Learning & Evaluation

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
ML1	We track basic program activities (e.g., participants served, services delivered).	Yes	1	Yes
ML2	We collect data on the individuals and communities we serve.	Yes	1	Yes
ML3	We have defined outcomes or goals for our programs.	No	2	Growth priority
ML4	We track progress toward our program outcomes.	No	2	Growth priority
ML5	We use data to inform program decisions and improvements.	No	3	Growth priority

ID	Statement	Answer	Stage	Favorable
ML6	Staff are trained to collect and use data consistently.	No	3	Growth priority
ML7	We use standardized tools or systems to collect and manage data.	No	3	Growth priority
ML8	We regularly review program data as a team.	No	3	Growth priority
ML9	We share program data with external stakeholders (e.g., funders, partners).	No	4	Growth priority
ML10	We use data to support fundraising and external communications.	No	4	Growth priority
ML11	We have staff or dedicated capacity responsible for data and evaluation.	Yes	4	Yes
ML12	We assess program effectiveness beyond outputs (e.g., changes in behavior, safety, or outcomes).	No	4	Growth priority
ML13	We partner with external evaluators, researchers, or learning partners when appropriate.	No	4	Growth priority
ML14	We use data and learning to adapt programs over time.	No	4	Growth priority
ML15	We have systems in place to ensure data quality and consistency.	No	4	Growth priority
ML16	We have a learning agenda or set of questions guiding our evaluation efforts.	No	5	Growth priority
ML17	We contribute data, insights, or practices to broader field learning.	No	5	Growth priority